

VOL. 01
YEAR 298
GALACTIC
EDITION

RICO1

RO THE GHOST FLEET

**CALCULATION AT THE
SALVAGE
THRESHOLD**
WHO DARES RECLAIM
WHAT THE STARS
HAVE FORGOTTEN?

GRAND ADMIRAL
JINX

AND THE
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PLUS: LOST FLEETS • FORBIDDEN TECHNOLOGY • GALACTIC UNDERWORLDS • AND MORE



Five hundred and forty-seven generations of clean water — ending now, imperceptibly, in the taste of ash.

The Dragon narrows its ancient eyes. It has seen Sync-Break before. It has never held one back.

Elara leans away from what she already knows.

The Dewing holds. The Dewing lies.



Stillwater Convergence — where the jade holds, and the dark water does not.

The eddies are aligning faster than the models predicted.

Below the foamy churn, silver leviaths spiral into a newborn mouth — boldly, hopelessly cohesive.

The frontier is not the horizon. It is the overheat beneath the surface.



Tidalcross tallies its dead before the storm has even named itself.

Deckmaster Liora's order — sharp, stoic, final — a conjuration against the green-gray sky.

Hull against hull. Amber light guttering in the plazas. The tide rises with devilish patience.

Every sailor knows the count. The city breathes it. Survival, practiced to the bone.



Tidalcross, mid-tier. Where the rope holds and the sardines don't.

Mara — affable emissary of no one in particular — trades kelp for broth above the scramble.

Below: a gambler's smirk, a crate's collapse, a cascade of silver fish across the pavement.

The city seethes. She stays solidly, sacredly balanced.



Tidalcross tilts — and commerce does not pause.

Mara of Crater City, scarred and certain, hawks glowing algae above the hubbub of a dozen tongues. Kelp broth, fermented spice, salt wind rattling lanterns: the bazaar's surfeit of sensation, ordinary as breathing.

At the edge, a scout's clench on cold steel. Nearby, a pickpocket peels a copper token from the crowd. The guard grins — it is, after all, the fortieth time today.



Tidalcross. Midtide.

The water doesn't stop the market — it joins it.

Lira hefts the crate. The automaton glides past. Children shriek through the kelp-swirled shallows, exultant.

Above, the tide charts count down. Below, every sodden step is its own quiet declaration — endurance woven into the rhythm like a sheaf of well-taught muscle memory.



The doors seal. The surface becomes a memory.

Each marker counts down what daylight remains — dutifully, without mercy.

Amber-streaked pylons rise from the deep: the Blue Cathedral, traversed at last.

A breath away from the point of no return. The pressure does not negotiate.



The Abyss Verge — where Tidalcross ends and the deep begins.

A surface trader, mortally out of place, calls his wares into the crushing dark.

The Deep Folk study him frostily. They have always known what he cannot survive without.

Two worlds. One vial of oxygen. Barter, remorselessly humane.



THE WEIGHT OF FOURTEEN STORIES.

She traces grief through reinforced glass — grandmother, child, father — each ache trickling into her Aura-Net like a wound the tenements cannot close.

Contraband stacked at her boots. A Magnetica rune vibrating against her ribs. The Vitalis storm gathering, ineluctably, in the canopy below.

Between duty and the hollow calculus of the irreversible — Captain Lyssa 'Storm-Tooth' hesitates. The frame holds her there. It does not forgive.



Carrion Gate. The axis is wrong.

Korg tilts beneath basalt older than its own ruin — the Rust-Titan suit groaning through one last sojourn, joints articulating their reluctant tribute to a frame kept running past purpose.

Vex crouches where vine overtook stone. Carven reads equations stagnant water cannot hold. Shadownip: darker than the dark, tending to Korg's breath with the cumulative patience of someone who assimilates thresholds for a living.

Three operatives. One geometry of elongated shadows. The moment before action ignites — tenderly, irreversibly suspended.



Tidalcross. Where commerce declares itself sacred — and the harbor learns to disagree.

Behind Tovin, Cyllian's Energia-scarred gauntlets burn fiercer. The Tether reads the room before the room does.

Tovin glances out past the frame — that small, spittle-dampened shrug that says: yes, this is exactly as delinquent as it looks.

Three ideologies. One decidedly wrong quay. The ledgers will not survive the introduction.



Zone 3 forgets its margins — but the margins remember everything.

The Hierarchs aren't receiving a prophecy.

They're misinterpreting an apology.

Below the salt air and the broken solar-sail frames, something vast and earnest acknowledges the overthrow with what might be grace.



Platform 47. The eleventh hour of a trial no one authorized.

The Lumina barriers shatter. Two-hundred-and-fifty bodies hold their breath — and the cold moves in.

Ghost signals. A dock-worker's trembling foot. The rope's post driven clean through rusted iron, immutably, by accident.

Vex's command is low and absolute. The receiver drops. Across the fractured plaza, two ardent strangers conclude the same wretched thing — some arenas permit no exit.



Crater City's sterile order ends at the alcove door.

Forbidden schematics blazon the dark — each violet line a quiet equation of rebellion.

Ozone and hot ceramic. The scent of things being remade without permission.

For one heartbeat, the geometry holds. Then the parts drift apart — celestial bodies denying their own orbit.



Crater City. Fabrication Hall Seven.

Yield percentages climb. Defect counts follow.

The robotic arms move with the conscientiousness of a deity — fanatical, synchronized, cold.

No warmth reaches the floor. It never did.



Aetherion's outermost reach — where cause and effect have grown pliant, and the unglow-able remain.

Flick mimes the prelude to impossible physics. The snow refuses its cue.

Sable writes with the impeccable steadiness of one long accustomed to a world that tilts but does not break.

This is not exile. This is what the luminescent cities were too visionary — and too cowardly — to tend.



The signal dies in a hue the UV-grid was never built to speak.

Three centuries of fanaticism — calcifying, at last, into something inadequate.

The Elder's hand holds the Wall the way a practitioner holds a diagnosis: stoically, headlong into what cannot be reconciled.

Noctura's conquest does not announce itself. It moves through stone.



Five hundred metres down, the body becomes a negotiation.

The Archivist carries the surface's grief in coral — generations of unanswered signal, sealed and sinking.

Ahead: the scorched courier. Once a man. Now a living breadcrumb, molten and indistinguishable from the abyss that remade him.

Some pilgrimages guarantee you arrive somewhere you cannot leave unchanged.



The Ghost Fleet quarantined at the edge of reason — twenty vessels radiating a wrongness no ritual of thanks can dispel.

Alfrion of Cobalt Veil reads dead trajectories better than living politics.

Jinx extends a weathered hand — not greeting, but the calculus of those who salvage what others abandon.

Between them: the oldest question Luna has never answered — whether departure is elasticity or erasure.



The anteroom holds its breath — two silhouettes fractured by chain-link, neither wholly here.

Reality audits itself and finds thirteen errors.

Chen pays the Tether in stillness. Mira pays it in the word: **Steady.**

The grid between them — fence or mercy — persists. The threshold, uncrossed.



Crimson monotony. The sister-world burns below, systematically spent.

Three witnesses. One feather, adrift in recycled air — tangibly, inexhaustibly wrong.

Kael Ironroot, Silara of the Prism Veil, Chipster: a changeling convergence the station never accounted for.

Grace arrived. The machinery had no chamber for it.



THE SKYWELL SHAFT — CRATER CITY INTERIOR

Twenty miles of parceled gravity. Silence where screaming should live.

She steps off Platform Fifty-Seven. The Gravita stream seizes her — not violently, but with the surgical indifference of a city that has never learned mercy.

Below: dead tiers. Spirit Slag has claimed their power rations. Above: the Black Suns blaze without apology — hierarchy made spatial, worth measured in lumens. The shaft does not care which direction you fall.



Level 39. Where the city sends its shame downward.

Three truths descend: soldier, navigator, eco-bearer — each breath a negotiation with Therma, each step a psychic wound the ground refuses to forget.

Meredith reads the fractured junction like a dire prophecy carved in cooling runes. The new operative maps the Fracturing Plants below, where Resonantia screams its last into slag.

The furnace-glow casts no mercy. Only fractured silhouettes against an abyss of their own making.



Vortex Station, Algae Cathedral — where probability comes to unravel.

Carven Starwatcher has reached this moment across a thousand timelines. It ends the same.

Sparklefly does not kneel before order. Sparklefly does not choose the void.

Sparklefly laughs — and takes the third path nobody dreamed to calculate.



University Sphere Three — after the Dissonance.

Two mugs. Three shadows.

Grief does not require grandeur — only the empty space where a third hand should rest.

They choose forward. Not because the void is small. Because the other is still here.



Metronome Hall. Where every tick was once a choice she made.

The Oscilla Spectre does not lie — it only reminds.

She prescribed these rhythms. Now they writhe through her ribs like a mosaic coming apart.

The mask holds. The ticker beneath it does not.



Noetica flows freely between them — silver mist shaping memory into borrowed light.
The elder's childhood river, replayed ripple by ripple. Presto. Gone. Replayed again.
Something rankles beneath the reposeful exchange. Cold threads. An abominable patience.
She clamps her eyes shut. The pearl glow flares. The void, contorted, retreats.